

# *Town of Hampton*



## Select Board Agenda July 13, 2026

Posted: Library, Town Offices, Town website

Location: Hampton Academy Community Room

### SALUTE TO THE FLAG

1:00 p.m.

#### I. Facilitated Goal Setting Session

3:00 p.m.

#### I. Joint Meeting with Planning Board

##### 1. Facilitated Discussion for Vision of Future Growth

#### II. Closing Comments

#### III. Adjournment

## **HAMPTON SELECT BOARD / PLANNING BOARD**

**July 13, 2026 – 3:00 PM**

### **SELECT BOARD**

**PRESENT:** Carleigh Beriont, Chair  
Jeff Grip, Vice Chair  
Chuck Rage  
Amy Hansen  
Don Bliss

### **ABSENT:**

### **PLANNING BOARD**

**PRESENT:** Sharon Mullen, Chair  
Ward Galanis, Vice Chair  
John Tirrell  
Keith Lessard  
Richard Snetsky  
Ryan Pope

### **ABSENT:**

**STAFF IN ATTENDANCE:** Jamie Sullivan, Town Manager; Kristi Pulliam, Finance Director; Jason Bachand, Town Planner; Andrea Novotney, Planning Office Manager

**CALL TO ORDER:** Rick Alpers, Primex meeting facilitator, called the meeting to order at 3PM. Attendees introduced themselves.

**UNH EXTENSION COMMUNITY BUSINESS ENGAGEMENT PROGRAM (CBE):** Ms. Mullen explained the 12-month program aims to help communities develop, maintain, and grow a thriving local economy by connecting with businesses, organizations, and institutions. The program helps uncover and address key needs, overcome challenges, and seize opportunities for growth. A volunteer committee would need to be created to work with the CBE facilitators. She would like the approval of the Select Board to submit the Town into the queue to show the UNH Extension that Hampton would be interested in applying.

The Boards discussed that the Town of Exeter recently finished the CBE program. They are presenting their findings to the Exeter Select Board this evening.

Mr. Bachand noted that during the Plan NH Town Center Study Area Design Charrette there was minimal participation by the business community. The Planning Department has been looking for additional ways to engage with the business community.

Ms. Mullen stated the estimated cost for the program is \$4-\$9,000. The first step is to put the Town in the queue so UNH Extension is aware Hampton would be interested in applying, as they are determining which towns are interested in participating and how to allocate their funding.

It was the consensus of the Select Board to have the Planning Board indicate the Town's interest in the program to UNH Extension.

**ECONOMIC & COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT SUMMIT:** Ms. Mullen explained that earlier this year Nate Bernitz from UNH Extension gave a presentation to the Planning Board on strategies for business retention, expansion, and relationship building. The idea for a summit came out of that presentation, an opportunity to engage with the business and developer community and to listen and learn.

Mr. Bachand noted this summit could be geared towards those in the business community that did not participate in the Charrette. He explained that the Planning Office is applying for an additional Housing Opportunity Planning (HOP) Grant from InvestNH that is open to Housing Champion

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designated communities. This grant (\$1,000 - \$5,000 range) is geared towards supporting active efforts related to local housing. The Planning Office developed the idea of using this grant, if awarded, for a Housing and Economic Development Summit in 2027. Mr. Bachand and Ms. Novotney met with Jenn Rowden from the Rockingham Planning Commission last week to discuss the idea with her.

The Boards discussed potential economic development goals.

It was the consensus of the Select Board to move forward with the proposed Housing and Economic Development Summit.

**ZONING UPDATES:** Mr. Bachand explained that the first update will be to the definitions section of the Zoning Ordinance. Making sure that definitions are compiled in the definitions section or noted under which specific Section the definition can be found, that terms are defined once and consistent with state law, and that conditions or standards are removed from all definitions whenever possible. Also, every use in Section 5.1 should be defined in Section 1.5. This work will be done by the Planning Office.

Mr. Bachand recommended the next update be a build out analysis. This was recommended by Horsley Witten during the Zoning Audit as a guide for certain policy decisions.

**Dimensional requirements analysis:** A GIS exercise to compare the dimensional requirements in the Zoning Ordinance with the actual requirements of lots and development today. The data should be analyzed to see where there is significant mismatch. One of the goals of the Master Plan is to reduce non-conformity based on dimensional requirements.

**Suitability for greater housing density analysis:** A GIS exercise to identify suitable areas for greater housing density, in conjunction with the dimensional requirements analysis.

The cost for the build-out analysis would most likely need to be a Warrant Article. The remaining HOP Grant would not be enough to cover the cost.

**ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT COMMITTEE (EDC):** Ms. Mullen stated this proposed committee would be made up of professionals in the field willing to volunteer their expertise to the Town. This committee would report to the Select Board. The EDC and the CBE would be separate committees but would work together.

Ms. Hansen requested clarification on the mission of the proposed EDC. Ms. Mullen discussed economic and community resilience. The other Planning Board members discussed their goals for an EDC:

- Retaining current businesses, what is necessary to make them successful.
- Expanding current businesses.
- Attracting new business.
- Developing a non-residential tax base.
- Performing a SWOT (strength, weaknesses, opportunities, threats) analysis.
- Bringing recommendations to the community at large.
- How can the Town become more business aware.

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Mr. Bliss proposed the name Economic Resilience Committee instead for a more holistic approach.

Ms. Novotney provided examples of EDCs working on public engagement and outreach for Town projects that will have an impact on economic development. The Boards discussed looking at examples of EDCs in other Towns.

**RSA 79-E:** Ms. Novotney noted that HB 1103 was approved on July 2<sup>nd</sup> and will go in effect on August 31st. RSA 79-E:4-d will change its name from Office Conversion Zone to Residential Conversion Zone. In a town that has adopted RSA 79-E:4-d a qualifying structure will now mean a structure being used for office, *commercial*, or *industrial* use if such is being converted to residential use. This will need to go to ballot in 2027 to make this change.

The Town can raise the substantial rehabilitation threshold, which is currently 15% of the pre-rehabilitation assessed value or at least \$75,000, whichever is less, but to do so it must go back to ballot in 2027.

The Town may also amend the Public Benefit criteria but to do so it must also go back to ballot in 2027.

Ms. Novotney reviewed the draft RSA 79-E:4-d application and noted if the Board liked this application format, it can be adjusted and used for the RSA 79-E application. Examples of the proforma and project budget sheet used in the Lebanon RSA 79-E application, two Declaration of Covenant templates (Milford and Rochester), examples of modified Public Benefits (Keene and Durham), and proposed changes to the Hampton Public Benefits were provided.

The Boards discussed the RSA 79-E process. It was the consensus of the Select Board to have Mr. Grip, Mr. Pope, and Ms. Novotney work on:

- Addressing the substantial rehabilitation threshold
- Drafting the modified Public Benefits
- Drafting a Covenant Template
- Creating a financial review process

### **ADJOURNMENT**

**MOVED** by Mr. Lessard

**SECOND** by Mr. Grip

**VOTE: Unanimous**

**MOTION PASSED.**

**MEETING ADJOURNED: 4:51 p.m.**

Respectfully submitted,

Andrea Novotney, Office Manager Planning